

Institutional AI Strategy Research Brief: University of Florida, Arizona State University, and Marist University

Purpose for Tarleton context. This report is aligned to the internal Tarleton AI Strategy workshop preparation request: [Cook, Dr. Scott](#) asked the team to research the AI strategies of University of Florida, Arizona State University, and Marist University for a July 27 President’s Advisory Council session, with the intent to create case-study materials for Tarleton’s AI future discussion. ¹

Part 1 — Executive Summary

UF: Infrastructure-led institutional transformation

UF built its AI strategy around HiPerGator, AI Across the Curriculum, centralized academic coordination, and responsible-use guidance.

ASU: Platform-led enterprise experimentation

ASU is using governed AI platforms, OpenAI partnership activity, agentic AI, and internal product teams to scale AI across teaching, research, and operations.

Marist: Mission-led AI literacy and ethics

Marist’s three-year roadmap centers universal AI literacy, human-centered ethics, readiness plans, and a proposed Institute for Ethical AI.

Across the three institutions, **AI strategy has moved beyond pilots into institutional identity, governance, curriculum, and operating models.** UF positions itself as an “AI university” whose initiative “touches every corner of the university,” anchored by an NVIDIA-linked supercomputing investment and a university-wide curriculum strategy. ^{2 3} ASU frames AI through **Principled Innovation**, enterprise digital transformation, and governed platforms such as CreateAI, ChatGPT Edu, and internal AI product development. ^{4 5} Marist frames AI through **human-centered liberal arts identity**, a three-year roadmap, universal AI literacy, and ethical intelligence. ^{6 7}

The institutions differ most sharply in their **strategic archetypes**. UF is the most mature infrastructure-and-curriculum model: it connects supercomputing, faculty hiring, AI-designated courses, AI certificates, research computing, and formal use guidelines. [8](#) [3](#) [9](#) ASU is the most mature enterprise AI adoption model: it uses a central AI site, AI Acceleration team, CreateAI Platform, Digital Trust Guidelines, AI Innovation Challenge, Learning Design Suite, and OpenAI/ChatGPT Edu deployment to scale use cases across teaching, research, and work. [10](#) [5](#) [11](#) [12](#) [13](#) Marist is the newest and most explicitly values-led institutional roadmap: it has a documented three-pillar strategy, named steering committee, applied AI minor, AI Academy, ethics principles, and a proposed Institute for Ethical AI. [7](#) [14](#) [15](#)

For a mid-sized public regional university such as Tarleton, the strongest composite model is **not to copy one institution wholesale**, but to combine UF’s curriculum taxonomy and executive alignment, ASU’s governed platform and project intake model, and Marist’s annual-readiness planning and ethics-forward communications. This aligns with the workshop’s internal goal of using case studies to build a TSU one-page AI strategy around value, people/culture, engineering, governance/organization, and data. [1](#)

Part 2 — Institutional Profiles

1. University of Florida — “Building an AI University”

Institutional AI Vision & Strategy

UF’s public AI narrative is built around becoming a comprehensive AI university rather than a STEM-only AI adopter. Its “Building an AI University” page states that UF partnered with NVIDIA to host one of the world’s fastest higher-education supercomputers and then used that resource to transform the university as a whole. [2](#) UF’s AI Across the Curriculum page says “every profession uses AI; every program should teach it,” and argues that every student, regardless of major, should graduate with basic AI literacy. [8](#)

UF’s strategy is unusually explicit about workforce preparation. Its AI literacy model includes knowing and understanding AI, using and applying AI, evaluating and creating AI, and AI ethics. [8](#) UF also created a university-wide AI Fundamentals

certificate and discipline-specific AI certificates. ⁸ The Provost's Office is named as the "pivot point" for AI Across the Curriculum, which signals executive academic sponsorship. ⁸

Governance & Organizational Structure

UF established the Artificial Intelligence Academic Initiative Center, or AI² Center, in 2022 to provide centralized leadership for academic AI efforts. ¹⁶ The AI² Center coordinates AI academic programs and certificates, identifies engagement opportunities for faculty and students, organizes seminars and conferences, shares teaching resources, partners with career and external organizations, oversees the QEP, and manages the AI Learning Academy. ¹⁶ UF's guidelines also state that administrators evaluated existing policies and chose not to amend them specifically for AI because they judged existing regulations and policies sufficiently robust. ⁹

Academic Integration

UF is the strongest AI-across-the-curriculum case among the three. UF's accreditation-aligned Quality Enhancement Plan is "AI Across the Curriculum," and the institutional accreditation page says the initiative is designed to ensure all UF students across undergraduate, graduate, and professional programs can acquire AI knowledge, skills, and applications. ¹⁷ UF's course-designation framework includes four AI literacies plus an "AI Enabled" category, and UF's AI Education Committee reviews courses and awards designations. ⁹ UF reports 200+ AI-related courses on its central AI page and 12,000 annual AI-course enrollments on its "Building an AI University" page. ¹⁸ ²

Enterprise & Operational AI

UF's responsible-use guidance covers teaching, learning, research, and HR, including sections for instructors, students, researchers, and HR professionals. ⁹ The HR section recommends ethical frameworks, AI literacy training, responsible use in recruitment/performance/talent processes, bias detection, human oversight, and continuous monitoring, but the guidance does not document specific deployed HR systems in the sources reviewed. ⁹

Technology Ecosystem and Investment

UF's technology ecosystem is centered on HiPerGator. UF describes HiPerGator as the fastest supercomputer owned and operated by a U.S. university, anchored by a \$50 million gift from UF alumnus and NVIDIA co-founder Chris Malachowsky plus NVIDIA hardware, software, training, and services. ³ UF states that HiPerGator supports courses every semester and research projects led by more than 6,000 researchers, and powers Navigator AI, which gives faculty, students, and staff access to generative AI capabilities including Llama, ChatGPT, Gemini, Claude, and Diffusion. ³ UF also reports Board of Trustees approval of a \$24 million investment to acquire a more advanced HiPerGator version with NVIDIA DGX B200 systems. ³

Policies, Ethics & Risk Management

UF's 2023/2026 AI guidelines require AI use to be accessible, ethical, transparent, secure, and aligned with academic integrity and human values. ⁹ The guidelines advise users not to enter sensitive or restricted data into unapproved tools, to cite or disclose AI use when required, to keep humans in the loop for important academic/research/HR decisions, and to use only UF-approved or UF-provided tools for sensitive data. ⁹ UF specifically permits sensitive or restricted data with models deployed on UF HiPerGator but not with cloud models tagged "External" in NaviGator Chat. ⁹

Results & Outcomes

Documented outcomes include 200+ AI-related courses, 12,000 annual AI-course enrollments, 300+ AI-focused faculty, and 268+ AI-related internships via the Career Connection Center. ¹⁸ ² UF also states that it added more than 100 AI professors since 2020. ³

2. Arizona State University — Principled Innovation and Enterprise AI Integration

Institutional AI Vision & Strategy

ASU's AI strategy is grounded in its charter and Principled Innovation framework. ASU states that it is driving AI solutions to enhance teaching, learning, research, and digital transformation while focusing on outcomes rather than experimentation for

its own sake. ⁴ Its guiding tenets include that AI should augment human capability, innovation must align to the ASU charter, and access and inclusion must remain central. ⁴

ASU is also explicitly moving into agentic AI. Its AI site states that ASU is using agentic AI to personalize learning at scale, streamline operations, and empower faculty and staff with tools that surface insights and reduce repetitive work. ⁴

Governance & Organizational Structure

ASU's governance model is built around policy, digital trust, platform governance, and review processes. Its AI site names an Evaluation Framework for model testing, human review, and ongoing bias/equity evaluation; a Faculty Ethics Committee on AI Technology; and CreateAI as a governed environment for the ASU community. ⁴ ASU's Digital Trust Guidelines were reviewed and accepted by Enterprise Technology, Office of General Counsel, and the University Provost. ¹¹ ASU's AI tools undergo the VITRA process, and departments submit assessment requests for approved departmental use. ¹⁹

Academic Integration

ASU lists AI-focused undergraduate programs, graduate programs, certificates, and 40 individual AI courses. ⁴ Its Learning Design Suite provides faculty and instructional designers with purpose-built AI tools grounded in ASU academic standards, including Syllabot, assignment-language support, discussion-prompt generation, learning-objective tools, and syllabus support. ²⁰ ASU's AI Journey Volume 4 also describes AI integration in first-year writing and a new PhD in Artificial Intelligence, but this source is a narrative publication rather than a governance document. ²¹

Enterprise & Operational AI

ASU has the strongest documented enterprise implementation profile. OpenAI reports that ASU integrated ChatGPT Edu into teaching, research, and operations and launched an AI Innovation Challenge in February 2024 requiring proposals in teaching/learning, research for public good, or future of work. ¹³ OpenAI also reports that by July ASU had received over 400 proposals and activated more than 200 projects across most departments and colleges. ¹³ ASU's CreateAI Platform

supports secure AI hosting, developer APIs, custom deployment, enterprise scaling, data ownership/privacy, ethical AI guardrails, systems/API integration, and agentic workflows. [5](#)

Technology Ecosystem

ASU's ecosystem includes OpenAI/ChatGPT Edu, CreateAI Platform, Microsoft 365 Copilot, and internal AI tools. The AI Innovation Challenge is presented as a collaboration among ASU, OpenAI, and CreateAI, with complimentary access to ChatGPT Edu and CreateAI for approved projects. [12](#) ASU's Microsoft 365 Copilot page says ASU faculty and staff can request paid access through their units, with supervisor/business operations approval required. [22](#)

Faculty & Staff Enablement

ASU's AI Help and Learning Design Suite pages emphasize workshops, tutorials, toolkits, consultations, and faculty feedback loops. [4](#) [20](#) ASU also maintains an AI Acceleration team with product, data science, engineering, security, MLOps, data architecture, and innovation specialist roles, and the team's mission is to use AI and machine learning to improve student experience, research excellence, and societal impact. [10](#)

Policies, Ethics & Risk Management

ASU's Digital Trust Guidelines warn users not to share confidential student, personnel, contractual, research, institutional, or proprietary information with generative AI tools unless appropriate safeguards are in place. [11](#) The guidelines also emphasize IP considerations, transparency about AI use, and vendor IT risk assessment for new tools. [11](#) ASU's central policy page also links academic integrity, privacy, personnel-records, research-integrity, citation, and syllabus-statement resources. [19](#)

Results & Outcomes

ASU's documented outcomes include more than 400 AI Innovation Challenge proposals and more than 200 activated projects by July 2024, according to OpenAI. [13](#) ASU also documents concrete operational/academic tools such as DegreeMe, Meletai, Language Buddy, CreateAI Builder, and Learning Design Suite tools. [4](#) [5](#) [20](#)

3. Marist University — Human-Centered AI Strategy and Ethical Intelligence

Institutional AI Vision & Strategy

Marist's AI strategy is framed as "Marist + AI," built on the belief that technology should advance human values rather than replace them. ⁶ Marist describes a three-year strategic roadmap developed through cross-divisional collaboration, open forums, facilitated discussions, and benchmarking of peer and aspirant institutions. ⁶ President Kevin Weinman states that AI is reshaping teaching, learning, and work, and that Marist is positioned to prepare students to lead in a world shaped by AI opportunities and threats. ⁶

Governance & Organizational Structure

Marist documents the Marist + AI Steering Committee, with faculty, staff, and student representatives, and states that the AI Committee will conduct annual reviews of the vision to assess progress and emerging opportunities/challenges. ⁶ The full framework names steering, academic, and operations committees, including Kevin Gaugler and Diane Hart as Steering Committee co-chairs, Carolyn Matheus and Jeff Midgley as Academic Committee co-chairs, and Haseeb Arroon and Mike Caputo as Operations Committee co-chairs. ⁷

Academic Integration

Marist's strategy includes AI readiness plans, curriculum integration, faculty/staff development, operational effectiveness, AI Academy, credentialed opportunities, AI-enhanced student success, and informal engagement. ⁶ Its April 7, 2026 announcement says the AI Academy will launch with a one-credit interdisciplinary AI Literacy Bootcamp for students, and that additional badges and micro-credentials are in development along with faculty self-paced modules. ²³ Marist's Applied AI minor requires AI Literacy, Ethics of AI, and Applied AI plus electives from schools across the university. ¹⁴

Enterprise & Operational AI

Marist's documented operational AI is mostly strategic rather than implemented. The framework says operational areas will evaluate how AI can improve administrative processes, student experiences, and staff focus on higher-value work, and it specifically mentions enrollment marketing examining how AI is

changing high-school students' college search behavior. [7](#) It also states Marist will integrate predictive analytics and intelligent support tools across the student journey from admission through graduation and career launch. [7](#)

Technology Ecosystem and Partnerships

Marist's strategy emphasizes partnerships more than named platforms. The framework cites a more than 30-year partnership with IBM and collaborations with other industry pioneers as part of Marist's readiness for AI. [7](#) Marist's April 2026 announcement says the Hudson Valley AI Summit included Google, NYU Langone Health, State of New York, Westchester Medical Center, Central Hudson, and an IBM "AI for Impact" session. [23](#)

Policies, Ethics & Risk Management

Marist's ethics statement formalizes six guiding principles: human-centeredness, ethical oversight, social impact, environmental awareness, equal access and opportunity, and community engagement. [15](#) It commits to human oversight, ethical review, transparency, accountability, fairness, bias education, privacy considerations, environmental impact awareness, access, and open dialogue. [15](#)

Results & Outcomes

Marist's documented results are mostly commitments and program launches rather than measured outcomes. Documented assets include the AI strategy, Applied AI minor, forthcoming AI Academy, planned badges/micro-credentials, readiness plans, funded innovation grants, and a proposed Institute for Ethical Artificial Intelligence. [23](#) [7](#) [14](#)

Part 3 — Comparative Analysis Matrix

Dimension	University of Florida	Arizona State University	Marist University
Vision	Build an AI university across all disciplines. 2	AI for teaching, research, and digital transformation under Principled Innovation. 4	Human-centered “Marist + AI” rooted in ethical intelligence. 6
Governance	Provost-centered curriculum strategy; AI ² Center; AI Education Committee. 8 16 9	Evaluation Framework; Faculty Ethics Committee; Digital Trust; VITRA; AI Acceleration. 4 19 10	Steering, academic, and operations committees with annual reviews. 6 7
Academic integration	AI Across the Curriculum; QEP; AI certificates; course designations. 17 9	AI degrees/ certificates/ courses; Learning Design Suite; AI-informed writing. 4 20 21	Applied AI minor; AI Academy; bootcamp; badges/ microcredentials. 14 23
Faculty/staff support	AI Learning Academy; AI ² Center; UFIT/ CITT resources. 16 9	AI Help, Learning Design Suite, AI Acceleration, workshops/ toolkits. 4 20 10	AI Guides, faculty modules, innovation grants planned. 7 23

Dimension	University of Florida	Arizona State University	Marist University
Student access	AI Fundamentals certificate; NaviGator AI access; AI Scholars/ Medallion noted in UF case sources. 8 3 24	ChatGPT Edu projects; DegreeMe; Language Buddy; AI courses. 13 4	AI Literacy Bootcamp; Applied AI minor; credentialing plans. 23 14
Enterprise AI	Guidance covers HR/research/ teaching; less public detail on deployed admin use cases. 9	Strongest: CreateAI, ChatGPT Edu, Learning Design Suite, agentic AI. 5 13 20	Strategy calls for enrollment, student support, admin-service improvements. 7
Technology partnerships	NVIDIA, HiPerGator, Navigator AI, DGX B200 refresh. 3	OpenAI, CreateAI, Microsoft Copilot, internal AI platforms. 12 22 5	IBM history; summit partners including Google and IBM. 7 23
Responsible AI	Detailed AI guidelines; data classification; risk assessment; human-in-loop. 9	Digital Trust Guidelines; IP/ privacy; vendor risk assessment. 11	Formal ethics statement and six principles. 15

Dimension	University of Florida	Arizona State University	Marist University
Funding	\$50M Malachowsky/ NVIDIA-linked anchor plus \$24M HiPerGator upgrade documented. 3	Funding amounts not found in reviewed sources; access is unit-paid for Microsoft 365 Copilot. 22	Funding amounts not found; framework notes potential future revenue from grants, foundations, corporate partnerships, lifelong learning. 7
Maturity	Highest curriculum/ infrastructure maturity.	Highest enterprise/ platform maturity.	Emerging, coherent mission-led roadmap.

Part 4 — Best Practices

- 1. Most innovative practice: ASU’s governed AI product ecosystem.** CreateAI combines secure hosting, APIs, data ownership, ethical guardrails, integration, and agentic workflows, making it the strongest operational model for institution-wide experimentation. [5](#)
- 2. Most scalable academic model: UF’s AI Across the Curriculum.** UF embedded AI literacy into accreditation/QEP structures, created course designations, and coordinated through the AI² Center, which makes the model more durable than a single program launch. [17](#) [9](#) [16](#)
- 3. Most mature responsible-use guidance: UF and ASU, for different purposes.** UF provides detailed role-specific guidance for instructors, students, researchers, and HR professionals, while ASU provides Digital Trust guidance tied to data privacy, IP, vendor risk, and tool review. [9](#) [11](#)

4. **Strongest values narrative: Marist.** Marist’s “and, not or” philosophy, AI ethics principles, annual review process, and proposed Institute for Ethical AI create a clear message that AI adoption must preserve human agency and mission identity. [6](#) [7](#) [15](#)
 5. **Strongest enterprise implementation evidence: ASU.** ASU’s OpenAI-reported 400+ proposals and 200+ activated projects, paired with internal platforms and teams, show a repeatable project-intake and scaling mechanism. [13](#) [10](#)
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Part 5 — Recommendations for a Mid-Sized Public Regional University

Quick Wins: 0–12 Months

- **Create a one-page AI strategy** using the workshop structure already identified for Tarleton: vision, value, people/culture, engineering, governance/organization, and data. [1](#)
- **Launch an AI Steering Council with academic, IT, student-success, faculty, staff, student, legal/compliance, and data-governance representation**, modeled on Marist’s cross-divisional steering approach and ASU’s Digital Trust review structure. [6](#) [11](#)
- **Publish interim AI guidance** for instructors, students, researchers, and staff using UF’s role-based approach and ASU’s privacy/IP guidance as templates. [9](#) [11](#)
- **Start an AI use-case intake process** modeled on ASU’s AI Innovation Challenge, requiring use cases to specify teaching/learning, research, operations, expected outcome, data sensitivity, and evaluation plan. [12](#) [13](#)

Mid-Term Initiatives: 1–3 Years

- **Build AI Across the Curriculum locally** by defining AI literacy outcomes, course designations, and discipline-specific pathways, drawing from UF’s four-literacy model and QEP approach. [8](#) [17](#)
- **Create an AI Academy or AI Learning Hub** offering student bootcamps, faculty/staff modules, communities of practice, and microcredentials, combining UF’s AI Learning Academy and Marist’s AI Academy model. [16](#) [23](#)

- **Stand up a governed AI platform strategy** that clarifies approved tools, data categories, access levels, and vendor risk review, using ASU’s CreateAI and Digital Trust model as the benchmark. [5](#) [11](#)
- **Prioritize student-success and advising use cases** such as syllabus bots, degree exploration, tutoring support, career preparation, and early-alert augmentation, based on ASU’s documented DegreeMe, Syllabot, and Learning Design Suite examples. [4](#) [20](#)

Long-Term Strategic Investments: 3–5 Years

- **Invest in institutional AI infrastructure proportionate to mission**, not necessarily a UF-scale supercomputer, but a secure environment for data, model access, experimentation, and research support. [3](#) [5](#)
- **Create a center or institute for responsible AI in regional public higher education**, modeled on UF’s AI² Center and Marist’s proposed Institute for Ethical AI, with responsibilities for curriculum, research, operations, faculty development, and partnerships. [16](#) [7](#)
- **Measure AI outcomes annually**, including AI-literacy participation, course coverage, student-success outcomes, operational productivity, risk incidents, faculty/staff adoption, and external partnerships, reflecting Marist’s annual review and progress-measurement approach. [6](#) [7](#)

Part 6 — Source Appendix

Source	Date	Type	Relevance
UF “Building an AI University” — https://ai.ufl.edu/about/building-an-ai-university/	Current page	Institutional strategy page	UF vision, timeline, AI university framing, metrics. 2

Source	Date	Type	Relevance
UF “AI Across the Curriculum” — https://ai.ufl.edu/teaching-with-ai/ai-across-the-curriculum/	Current page	Academic strategy page	AI literacy model, certificates, Provost role, faculty hiring. ⁸
UF Guidelines for Use of AI — https://ai.ufl.edu/guidelines/	Version 1: 2023; Version 2: 2026	Policy/guidance	Responsible use, risk, student/faculty/research/HR guidance. ⁹
UF AI ² Center — https://ai.ufl.edu/about/the-ai-center/	Current page	Governance/center page	Central academic AI leadership and staff structure. ¹⁶
UF HiPerGator — https://ai.ufl.edu/research/hipergator/	Current page	Technology/research infrastructure	Supercomputing, NVIDIA, Navigator AI, \$24M upgrade. ³
UF Publications & Guides — https://ai.ufl.edu/publications--guides/	2023–2026 listings	Source index	QEP, BlueSky, administrator guide, AI governance resources. ²⁵
ASU AI home — https://ai.asu.edu/	Current page	Institutional strategy page	Principled Innovation, governance components, agentic AI, tools. ⁴

Source	Date	Type	Relevance
ASU Policy and Resources — https://ai.asu.edu/policy-and-resources	Current page	Policy/resource hub	VITRA, Digital Trust, academic integrity, AI resources. ¹⁹
ASU Digital Trust Guidelines — https://ai.asu.edu/digital-trust-guidelines	Current page; linked to 2023 guidance	Responsible AI guidance	Privacy, IP, confidential data, vendor risk guidance. ¹¹
ASU AI Innovation Challenge — https://ai.asu.edu/AI-Innovation-Challenge	2024-present page	Use-case intake/ RFP	Proposal model, ChatGPT Edu/ CreateAI access, outcome documentation. ¹²
OpenAI ASU case — https://openai.com/index/asu/	2024	Partner case study	ChatGPT Edu, 400+ proposals, 200+ activated projects. ¹³
ASU CreateAI Platform — https://ai.asu.edu/ai-tools/createai-platform	Current page	Technology platform	Secure AI, APIs, data ownership, ethical frameworks, agentic layer. ⁵

Source	Date	Type	Relevance
ASU Learning Design Suite — https://ai.asu.edu/ai-tools/learning-design-suite	Current page	Faculty/teaching tool suite	Syllabot, learning design tools, faculty feedback model. ²⁰
ASU AI Acceleration Team — https://ai.asu.edu/ai-tools/ai-acceleration-team	Current page	Organizational structure	Product, engineering, data science, MLOps team roles. ¹⁰
Marist AI Strategy — https://www.marist.edu/marist100/ai-strategy	Current page	Institutional strategy page	Three-year roadmap, steering committee, three pillars. ⁶
Marist AI Strategy Announcement — https://www.marist.edu/-/marist-ai-strategy-2026	April 7, 2026	Press release	AI Academy, bootcamp, Applied AI minor, summit partners. ²³

Source	Date	Type	Relevance
Marist AI Framework PDF/ page — https://www.marist.edu/documents/d/guest/maristuniversity-ai-report-feb2026	February 2026	Strategic framework	Committees, readiness plans, institute proposal, measurement. ⁷
Marist Ethics Statement — https://www.marist.edu/documents/d/guest/maristuniversity-ai-report-ethicsstatement-feb2026	February 2026	Ethics framework	Six principles and responsible AI commitments. ¹⁵
Marist Applied AI minor — https://www.marist.edu/applied-ai	Current page	Academic program page	Minor requirements and interdisciplinary electives. ¹⁴